

Maria Silva

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LLB and LLM graduate with practical experience supporting complex disputes, high-volume document management and client-facing legal work at BCLP, Citizens Advice and Q-Legal. Experienced in reviewing evidence, maintaining organised case files, tracking deadlines across concurrent matters, preparing hearing bundles and drafting procedural documents. Strong legal research and written communication skills, with a background in both dispute resolution and regulatory matters.

EDUCATION

Comparative and International Dispute Resolution LLM — Merit Sept 2024 – Oct 2025

Queen Mary University of London

- Modules in international arbitration, dispute resolution procedure, evidence analysis and advanced legal research
- Dissertation on data protection and the development of GDPR across jurisdictions — Distinction, 75%

Law LLB — 2:1 Sept 2020 – June 2024

University College London

- Modules in Alternative Dispute Resolution, Advanced Contract Law, Commercial Law and Company Law

International Foundation Programme — Law and International Relations Sept 2019 – June 2020

King's College London

- Awarded the Leaders of Tomorrow prize (top 20 of a 200-student cohort; partial funding toward undergraduate degree)

EXPERIENCE

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Aug 2023 – Feb 2024

Legal Placement Student — International Arbitration

- Supported a complex investment arbitration: reviewed and organised large volumes of evidence for procedural submissions and the Claimant's memorial
- Amended sections of the memorial; drafted procedural orders and procedural histories; conducted legal research to a tight brief
- Became the sole junior supporting the team shortly before a significant deadline: coordinated outstanding documents, tracked actions and liaised with an external translator to ensure on-time submission
- Maintained structured electronic case files; monitored and flagged procedural deadlines
- Received feedback from a partner and associate that performance was comparable to a newly qualified solicitor

Bryan Cave Leighton Paisner LLP (BCLP) · London Feb 2024 – Aug 2024

Legal Placement Student — Real Estate Disputes

- Supported hearing preparation: reviewed documents, prepared electronic bundles and assisted with skeleton arguments and court materials
- Conducted legal and factual research on rights of light, easements, leasehold issues and landlord and tenant disputes
- Managed large volumes of confidential documents across several concurrent matters with competing deadlines
- Assisted with court filings, hearing logistics, matter opening and closure, deadline tracking and cost comparisons
- Maintained matter records via iManage; prepared client-facing notes

Citizens Advice East Berkshire · Maidenhead

Legal Adviser

July 2026 – Present

- Manages a varied caseload covering welfare benefits, employment, housing, family, debt and consumer matters from initial interview through to submission
- Takes detailed factual statements, establishes chronologies and identifies relevant legal and evidential issues
- Drafts correspondence, prepares applications and document schedules, maintains confidential case records and meets deadlines across concurrent files
- Advises clients on procedural requirements and options; translates complex rules into clear, practical guidance for vulnerable individuals

Q-Legal · London

Oct 2024 – Jan 2025

Legal Adviser

- Managed a data-privacy matter from client instruction to formal written advice letter under a qualified solicitor's supervision
- Researched UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018 obligations for a data-driven start-up, including children's personal data and adtech
- Identified legal and compliance risks arising from the client's data processing and recommended practical mitigations
- Coordinated with the client and supervising solicitor to meet the agreed deadline; translated statutory requirements into commercially focused written advice

Adobe · London

June 2022 – Aug 2022

Legal Intern

- Reviewed and amended software licensing agreements; identified contractual risks and assessed alignment with internal legal and compliance requirements
- Reviewed confidentiality and data-processing provisions; researched UK GDPR, EU GDPR and cross-border personal data transfer requirements
- Liaised with sales, legal and international business teams to resolve contractual queries and reconcile commercial objectives with legal risk
- Prepared and delivered an internal presentation on breach-of-contract risks and mitigation measures

SKILLS

Languages: Portuguese (native), English (fluent), Spanish (basic)

Technical skills: Legal and commercial research; documentary analysis; document review; electronic bundling; electronic court filing portals; iManage; case management and time-recording systems; Microsoft Word, Excel and PowerPoint; legal research databases; concise report and correspondence drafting

Case and evidence management: Evidence review, hearing bundle preparation, procedural histories, structured case-file organisation, deadline tracking across concurrent matters